

French A1 — Week 12 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner French | Week 12

Theme: Final Performance and Course Close

What Week 12 Is For

Week 12 is not a test.

It is an opportunity to show what you can do in French after twelve weeks of study. The final performance is a demonstration — a real conversation and a short written message that prove you have reached A1 level. You will not be graded on whether every word is perfect. You will be assessed on whether you can communicate.

You have already done harder things in this course. If you could navigate a pharmacy in French last week, you can do this.

What the Final Performance Involves

Part A — Spoken Role Play (5–7 minutes)

You will have a conversation in French with your instructor. The setting is informal — you have just met someone, or you are helping someone navigate a situation.

Your conversation will move through some or all of these areas:

- Introduce yourself: who you are, where you are from, what you do
- Make a plan: suggest something to do together, agree on a time and place
- Give directions: help the other person get somewhere in the city
- Describe a place: your home, your neighbourhood, a place you like

You do not need to memorize a script. Practice the topics. Know your vocabulary. Then speak.

Part B — Written Message (8–10 sentences)

You will write a short message to a French-speaking contact — someone you have just met who wants to know more about you.

Your message must include:

- An introduction (who you are, where you are from, what you do)
- A description of your daily routine (at least 2 sentences)
- Something you enjoy doing
- A suggestion to meet or do something together
- At least one question for the other person

You may use the Week 12 phrase bank during Part B. You may not read a prepared script for Part A.

How to Prepare

Between Session 23 and Session 24:

1. **Practice the role play topics out loud** — not in your head. Say your introduction, make your plan, give directions, out loud, alone, as if talking to someone. Three times through minimum.
2. **Draft your written message** — write it, read it aloud, then improve it. Check: are the articles correct? Do adjectives agree? Are the contractions right (*au, du*)?
3. **Skim the phrase bank** — the Week 12 phrase bank collects the most useful expressions from across the course. Spend 5–10 minutes with it the evening before Session 24 to remind yourself what is in it. You do not need to memorize it. During Part B (written message), you may have it open as a reference — it is a support tool, not a test of what you can recall.
4. **Prepare one or two repair phrases** — know how to say "*I don't know how to say that in French*" and "*Could you repeat that?*" These are not admissions of failure — they are proof that you know how to communicate.
5. **Sleep.** Rest is more useful the night before than another hour of cramming.

What Counts as Success at A1

You have demonstrated A1 competency when you can:

- ☐ Introduce yourself without preparation in 4–5 sentences
- ☐ Ask and answer basic questions about your life, work, and interests
- ☐ Make plans with someone — suggest an activity, agree on a time and place
- ☐ Give and follow basic directions
- ☐ Order food or ask for help in a transactional situation
- ☐ Write a personal message of 8+ sentences that is clear and mostly correct

This is a significant achievement. Most adults who "learn French" never get here. You can now communicate in French in real situations.

Mistakes Are Expected

No A1 student produces perfect French. Mistakes at this level are normal, expected, and not a sign of failure.

What the instructor is looking for:

- Can you get your meaning across?
- Do you keep going when you get stuck?
- Do you recover from mistakes rather than shutting down?
- Do you use a range of the French you have learned?

A student who tries a complex sentence and makes a small grammar error is demonstrating more than a student who only uses one safe pattern they have memorized. Ambition is rewarded.

If you don't know a word, say: "*Comment dit-on...?*" and keep going. That is exactly what fluent speakers do.

Example: What Part A Might Look Like

Instructor (as French stranger): *Bonjour! Vous êtes nouveau ici?*

Student: *Bonjour! Oui — je m'appelle Sarah, je suis américaine. Je viens de New York mais j'habite ici depuis deux ans. Et vous?*

Instructor: *Je suis français — je suis arrivé le mois dernier. C'est difficile de trouver des bonnes boulangeries ici!*

Student: *Oh, il y a une très bonne boulangerie à cinq minutes d'ici! Vous voulez que je vous explique comment y aller?*

Instructor: *Oui, avec plaisir!*

Student: *Alors, vous allez tout droit jusqu'au feu, puis vous tournez à gauche. La boulangerie est à côté du supermarché.*

Instructor: *Merci! Et vous — qu'est-ce que vous faites ici le week-end?*

Student: *J'aime aller au cinéma... et je vais souvent au marché le dimanche. Il y a un très bon marché près d'ici. Est-ce que vous voulez y aller ensemble samedi matin?*

This is six exchanges. It includes: introduction, giving directions, describing activities, making a plan. No sentence is perfect. It is very good A1 French.

What Comes After A1

When you complete French A1, you are ready to begin French A2.

What A2 adds:

- Talking about the past: *passé composé* (what you did yesterday, last week, last year)
- The *imparfait* (describing what things were like)
- A richer range of vocabulary for work, travel, and social situations
- Object pronouns: *je le vois, je lui parle*
- More complex sentence structures

You are not starting from zero in A2. Every structure you have learned — être, avoir, regular verbs, irregular verbs, aller + infinitif, modals, partitives, prepositions — carries forward and is reinforced at A2 level. A2 builds on A1; it does not replace it.

The single most useful thing you can do between A1 and A2: spend 5–10 minutes per day reading or listening to very simple French — news in simple French, a children's book, a French podcast for learners. Keeping the language present between courses is what prevents the knowledge from fading.

Crescere — French A1 Week 12 | Questions? Contact your instructor.